Associate practice questions — set 3

10 free questions for the Claude Certified Associate – Foundations exam (CCAO-F). The correct option and its reasoning appear under each question — read them through, or cover the answer block and treat it as a timed self-check.

Question 1 **Workflow Integration and Solution Design**

A department proposes using Claude to improve onboarding. What evidence should be gathered first to define the use case?

A. Gather a commitment that introducing AI will reduce the department's staffing requirements.

B. Gather a catalogue of Claude features without connecting them to onboarding needs.

C. Gather current tasks, pain points, source materials, exceptions, and measurable onboarding outcomes.

D. Gather only the department's preferred model name before defining the onboarding process.

Correct answer: C

Requirements analysis connects a real problem, available inputs, constraints, and success measures.

Question 2 **Prompting and Task Execution**

A researcher needs a report derived from five documents. What prompt structure best reduces missed requirements?

A. Request the complete final report through one broad and minimally specified sentence.

B. Request firm conclusions before Claude reads and compares the five source documents.

C. Request that Claude use every available format within the same final report.

D. Separate extraction, comparison, gap analysis, and synthesis with criteria for every stage.

Correct answer: D

Staged decomposition makes evidence handling and synthesis separately reviewable.

Question 3 | Product and Model Selection

A customer-service team plans to send model-written medical advice without clinician review. Why is this use case inappropriate as designed?

A. The design directly delegates a consequential health recommendation without qualified clinical oversight.

B. The design uses a medical topic without requiring the longest possible prompt.

C. The design incorrectly assumes Claude cannot draft any health-related educational information safely.

D. The design produces ordinary text instead of presenting the advice as an artifact.

Correct answer: A

The risk comes from unsupervised consequential advice, not from the topic being categorically unusable.

Question 4 | Output Evaluation and Validation | Select all that apply

Claude produces a market-size estimate from a mixture of 2022 and 2026 figures. Which two checks are needed before presenting it?

A. Average every available figure even when the sources measure different market scopes.

B. Verify every material figure against its cited source, publication date, and context.

C. Remove publication dates so older figures appear suitable for the current estimate.

D. Confirm the figures share compatible definitions, measurement units, and reporting periods.

Correct answer: B, D

Source and date verification tests factual accuracy. Explanation for D: Definition, unit, and period alignment tests whether the figures can validly be combined.

Question 5 **Configuration and Knowledge Management**

A team repeatedly analyzes the same product, competitors, and positioning documents across many conversations. Which product feature best centralizes that context?

A. Create a separate temporary chat whenever the team needs to analyze one document.

B. Create an artifact containing only the most recent answer from the analysis.

C. Create a maintained Project containing the shared knowledge sources and recurring instructions.

D. Use research mode without providing any of the team's relevant internal documents.

Correct answer: C

Projects provide reusable instructions and knowledge for continuing work around a shared subject.

Question 6 **Configuration and Knowledge Management**

A connected Drive folder contains drafts and approved policies with nearly identical names. What should the Project owner do?

A. Connect additional folders and allow Claude to infer which policies are authoritative.

B. Rename every policy file identically so their approval status appears more consistent.

C. Tell users that documents with newer writing styles should always receive priority.

D. Identify authoritative policies clearly and remove or label obsolete drafts in Project knowledge.

Correct answer: D

Knowledge curation must make authority and currency clear.

Question 7 **Prompting and Task Execution**

A previously reliable classification prompt begins failing after the input form changes. What should be checked first?

A. Check whether the revised input structure still matches the prompt's assumptions and examples.

B. Check whether Claude's interface logo changed when the input form was updated.

C. Check whether every historical output can be deleted before testing the revised form.

D. Check whether increasing response length would conceal the classification errors being observed.

Correct answer: A

A change in input format is a direct candidate cause and should be isolated before broader changes.

Question 8 | Output Evaluation and Validation

A summary accurately covers nine of ten required contract clauses. How should it be assessed?

A. Assess it as fully acceptable because the summary includes most required contract clauses.

B. Assess it as accurate but incomplete and identify the omitted clause for correction.

C. Assess it as hallucinated solely because one required contract clause was omitted.

D. Assess it as biased solely because the completed contract summary is relatively short.

Correct answer: B

Completeness is distinct from accuracy; omission of a required element is a measurable defect.

Question 9 | Prompting and Task Execution | Select all that apply

A brainstorming prompt keeps returning minor variations of one idea. Which two revisions are most useful?

A. Ask Claude to avoid repeating the same mechanism across the proposed brainstorming ideas.

B. Ask Claude to produce one longer version of the idea it already proposed.

C. Ask Claude for ideas from explicitly different perspectives, assumptions, or constraint sets.

D. Ask Claude to remove the business objective before generating additional creative ideas.

Correct answer: A, C

Distinct perspectives broaden the search space. Explanation for A: A non-repetition constraint targets superficial variations of the same concept.

Question 10 **Governance, Risk, and Responsible Use**

An associate notices that a generated performance-review draft uses different standards for similar employees. What is the appropriate response?

A. Send the draft because professional wording alone makes inconsistent evaluation standards acceptable.

B. Remove employee names and accept the remaining ratings without examining their standards.

C. Increase the certainty of each rating so differences between employees appear intentional.

D. Pause use, examine the inconsistent criteria for bias, and obtain qualified human review.

Correct answer: D

Potential unfairness in an employment context requires investigation and accountable review. END OF FLASH DRILL

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